cabled from Simla, “It is a tribute to your dedication, hard work, and talent.”

A great deal of misinformation and disinformation had been spread by vested interests about this technology mission. Agni had never been intended only as a nuclear weapon system. What it did was to afford us the option of developing the ability to deliver non-nuclear weapons with high precision at long ranges. That it provided us with a viable nonnuclear option was of the greatest relevance to contemporary strategic doctrines.

Great ire was raised by the test firing of Agni, according to a wel known American defence journal, especial y in the United States where Congressmen threatened to put a stop to al dual-use and missile-related technologies, along with al multinational aid.

Gary Milhol in, a so-cal ed specialist in missiles and warhead technologies, had made a claim in The Wal Street Journal that India had made Agni with the help of West Germany. I had a hearty laugh reading that the German Aerospace Research Establishment (DLR) had developed Agni’s guidance system, the first-stage rocket, and a composite nose cone, and that the aerodynamic